

The Last Light of the Everflame: The Lampers vs. The Temple of Light

Logline

As the sacred flame that has burned in Ecktoria for centuries begins to die, the ancient rivalry between the Lampers and the Temple of Light erupts into open conflict, forcing the player characters to choose sides in a battle that will determine the future of faith itself.

Core Theme

The conflict between tradition and innovation when a sacred truth begins to fail, is it better to die with the old ways or risk everything to create something new?

The Rivalry: Lampers vs. Temple of Light

Lampers (Traditionalists) Guardians of the flame, who believe the flame must be protected at all costs
Philosophy: The flame is a gift from the gods that must be preserved exactly as it is. To change it is to profane it.
Methods: Rituals passed down for centuries, strict adherence to tradition, protective wards
Leaders: High Lamper Aris Thorne (a stern traditionalist) and the Circle of Elders
Grievance: The Temple of Light seeks to “improve” the flame, which they see as a heresy

Temple of Light (Reformers) Believers that the flame’s decline is a sign that it must evolve or be replaced

Philosophy: The flame is not static but should evolve with the times. Its decline is a call for renewal.
Methods: New rituals, experimental techniques, attempts to “renew” the flame through science and faith
Leaders: High Luminary Seraphina Vale (charismatic reformer) and the Council of Illumination
Grievance: The Lampers are allowing the flame to die rather than embracing necessary change

The History of the Rivalry

For 200 years, these two institutions have been locked in a cold war over the flame:

The Schism of 1278: The Temple split from the Lampers after a theological dispute
The War of Light (1322): A brief but violent conflict that was eventually contained
The Current Tension: As the flame falters, both sides see this as proof their approach is correct

Key Locations

The Grand Temple of the Everflame (Divided)
Lamper Quarter: Traditional rituals, ancient wards, the dying flame
Temple of Light Annex: New altars, experimental flame chambers, research stations
The Divided Court: Where the two factions hold their competing ceremonies

The Archives of the Lampers (Under Siege)

The Original Lampers: Hoard ancient texts they believe hold the answer
Temple Researchers: Trying to access the archives to “improve” understanding
The Hidden Wing: A section both sides believe holds the truth about the flame

The Shadowed District (New Frontier)

The Unlit: Those who have abandoned both institutions
The Third Path: A small group seeking a way to resolve the rivalry
The Dying Light: Areas where the flame’s power has faded, revealing hidden truths

Major Factions/Characters

Lampers
High Lamper Aris Thorne: “The flame is perfect. To change it is to destroy it.”
The Circle of Elders: Guardians of tradition who resist any change
The Night Watchers: A militant sect protecting the flame from “heretical” influences

Temple of Light

High Luminary Seraphina Vale: “The flame must evolve or die. We have the answers.”
The Council of Illumination: Visionaries who believe in the flame’s potential
The Bright Hands: Technicians and mystics who develop new rituals

The Unlit

The Shadowed One: A mysterious figure who claims the flame is a lie
The Lightless: Those who have given up hope in both institutions
The Keepers of Memory: Those who preserve the flame’s history outside official records

The Third Path

Gwen of the Open Road: “There is a way between the two that does not require choosing.”
The BridgeBearers: A group trying to mediate the conflict
The Pathfinders: Those searching for a new solution outside the rival institutions

Core Mechanics

Flame Timer (7 segments) The strength of the sacred flame
Lamper Action: Traditional rituals that stabilize the flame but slow its decline
Temple Action: Experimental techniques that may restore the flame but

risk disaster tem **Third Path Action:** Unique solutions that could create a new path but require trust

tem[Faith Timer (6 segments)] The city's faith in the flame

tem **Lamper Influence:** +1 segment per successful traditional ritual tem

Temple Influence: +1 segment per successful experimental ritual tem **Third**

Path Influence: +1 segment when they mediate successfully

tem[Rivalry Timer (6 segments)] Tension between the factions

tem **Lamper Action:** +1 segment when they deny Temple requests tem

Temple Action: +1 segment when they attempt to seize control tem **Third**

Path Action: 1 segment when they mediate successfully

tem[Obligation Timers] Personal ties to the conflict

tem **Lamper Obligation:** Ties to tradition, oaths to the Circle tem **Temple**

Obligation: Ties to innovation, promises to the Council tem **Third Path**

Obligation: Ties to both, creating a precarious balance

¶ **ceringpesection Narrative Threads**

tem[The Dying Flame]tem Why is the flame failing? Is it natural decline or something more sinister? tem What is the true nature of the flame? Is it divine or something else? tem What happened to the last High Lamper who tried to change the rituals?

tem[The Rivalry's Edge]

tem What does the Temple of Light know that the Lampers are hiding? tem

Who is behind the recent attacks on Temple researchers? tem What would

happen if both factions disappeared tomorrow?

tem[The Third Path]

tem Is there a way to save the flame without choosing a side? tem What

ancient knowledge might resolve the conflict? tem Who is pulling the strings

behind the scenes?

¶ **ceringpesection Player Hooks**

tem A PC has a connection to the Lampers (apprentice, family member, initiate)

tem A PC has ties to the Temple of Light (student, researcher, convert) tem A PC

is an Unlit who knows the truth about the flame's decline tem A PC has a bond

with the Third Path (they saved you once) tem A PC is related to a key figure in

the conflict (a child of the High Lamper or High Luminary)

¶ **ceringpesection Sample Scenes**

tem[The Divided Court] The high officials of both factions are holding competing ceremonies as the flame flickers. The PCs must:tem Prevent the ritual

- from becoming violent
- tem Determine who has the right to lead the ceremony
- tem Deal with the fact that both rituals are accelerating the flame's decline
- tem[The Archives Under Siege] The Temple researchers have gained access to the archives, and the Lampers are trying to stop them. The PCs must:
 - tem Navigate between the two groups without taking sides
 - tem Discover if the archives hold the key to saving the flame
 - tem Prevent the destruction of irreplaceable knowledge
- tem[The Shadowed District] The Unlit have discovered something about the flame's true nature. The PCs must:
 - tem Gain the trust of those who have abandoned faith
 - tem Determine if their knowledge is real or dangerous delusion
 - tem Decide whether to share this knowledge with either faction
- tem[The BridgeBearers' Dilemma] The Third Path is in danger as both sides see them as traitors. The PCs must:
 - tem Protect the bridgebuilders from attack
 - tem Negotiate with both factions to buy time
 - tem Decide if the Third Path is the solution or just another path to destruction

large centering p section Consequences

- tem[Success (Flame Restored)]tem The flame is restored, but the city is divided between those who support the Lampers and those who support the Temple
- tem The Third Path becomes a recognized institution, but their role is limited
- tem The city's faith is stronger but now fractured between old and new interpretations
- tem[Failure (Flame Extinguished)]
 - tem The city falls into chaos as both institutions collapse
 - tem The Temple of Light blames the Lampers for the flame's death
 - tem The Lampers blame the Temple for "corrupting" the flame
 - tem A dark age begins as faith in any institution fades
- tem[Compromise (New Light)]
 - tem A new understanding of the flame emerges, but it requires both traditions to adapt
 - tem The Third Path becomes the new religious authority, but faces constant challenges
 - tem The city moves forward, but the wounds of the conflict will take generations to heal
- tem[Radical Choice (The Third Path Wins)]
 - tem The Third Path is proven right, and both factions are forced to accept a new path
 - tem The High Lamper and High Luminary are both deposed
 - tem A new era begins where faith and reason coexist, but the old ways are gone forever